gun at Navjot. At this, Sourav's first reaction was to drop to the ground and cover his face in fright, but then he started pleading with the boy and dragged Navjot away as quickly as he could. Looking back at the incident, it seems a funny scene in some ways, but it must have been pretty scary at the time!

Soon after returning to India after a generally disappointing tour of England on the field, I was made captain of India at the age of twenty-three, replacing Azhar, who had been captain since 1990. It was time for the team to make a fresh start and get back to winning ways as soon as possible.

India in the 1996 World Cup

6th match. India v Kenya at Cuttack. 18 February 1996
Kenya 199–6 (50/50 ov); India 203–3 (41.5/50 ov)
India won by 7 wickets (with 49 balls remaining)

10th match. India v West Indies at Gwalior. 21 February 1996
West Indies 173 (50/50 ov); India 174–5 (39.4/50 ov)
India won by 5 wickets (with 62 balls remaining)

19th match. India v Australia at Mumbai. 27 February 1996
Australia 258 (50/50 ov); India 242 (48/50 ov)
Australia won by 16 runs

24th match. India v Sri Lanka at Delhi. 2 March 1996
India 271–3 (50/50 ov); Sri Lanka 272–4 (48.4/50 ov)
Sri Lanka won by 6 wickets (with 8 balls remaining)

29th match. India v Zimbabwe at Kanpur. 6 March 1996
India 247–5 (50/50 ov); Zimbabwe 207 (49.4/50 ov)
India won by 40 runs

2nd quarter-final. India v Pakistan at Bangalore. 9 March 1996
India 287–8 (50/50 ov); Pakistan 248–9 (49/49 ov)
India won by 39 runs

1st semi-final. India v Sri Lanka at Kolkata. 13 March 1996
Sri Lanka 251–8 (50/50 ov); India 120–8 (34.1/50 ov)
Sri Lanka won by default